

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT

POLICY MANUAL

VOLUME 3

Policy: 301.16 Respiratory Protection Policy

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PURPOSE

To protect the health of employees exposed in the course of their work to airborne contaminants, physical hazards, and biological agents through the use of respirators appropriate to protect employees from the respiratory hazards present in their particular environment. This policy will minimize occupational exposure to toxic substances.

INTENT

The intent of this policy is to enhance the protection of worker health, promote more effective use of respirators, and clarify the policies and procedures employees must follow when working in potentially hazardous environments.

DEFINITIONS

- A. AIR-PURIFYING RESPIRATOR: a respirator with an air-purifying filter, cartridge, or canister that removes specific air contaminants by passing ambient air through the air-purifying element.
- B. ATMOSPHERE SUPPLYING RESPIRATOR: a respirator that supplies the respirator user with breathing air from a source independent of the ambient atmosphere and includes supplied-air respirators (SARs) and self-contained breathing apparatus (SCBA) units.
- C. EMPLOYEE EXPOSURE: exposure to a concentration of an airborne contaminant that would occur if the employee were not using respiratory protections.
- D. FIT TEST: the use of a protocol to qualitatively or quantitatively evaluate the fit of a respirator on an individual. (See also Qualitative fit test QLFT and Quantitative Fit test QNFT.)
- E. HIGH EFFICIENCY PARTICULATE AIR FILTER (HEPA): a filter that is at least 99.97% efficient in removing monodisperse particles or 0.3 micrometers in diameter. The equivalent NIOSH 42 CFR 84 particulate filters are the N100, R100 and P100 filters.
- F. IMMEDIATELY DANGEROUS TO LIFE OR HEALTH (IDLH): an atmosphere that poses an immediate threat to life, would cause irreversible adverse health effects, or would impair an individual's ability to escape from a dangerous atmosphere.
- G. NEGATIVE PRESSURE RESPIRATOR: a respirator in which the air pressure inside the facepiece is negative during inhalation with respect to the ambient air pressure outside the respirator.

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- H. OXYGEN DEFICIENT ATMOSPHERE: an atmosphere with an oxygen content below 19.5% by volume.
- I. POSITIVE PRESSURE RESPIRATOR: a respirator in which the pressure inside the respiratory inlet covering exceeds the ambient air pressure outside the respirator.
- J. PRESSURE DEMAND RESPIRATOR: a positive pressure atmosphere-supplying respirator that admits breathing air to the facepiece when the positive pressure is reduced inside the facepiece by inhalation.
- K. QUALITATIVE FIT TEST (QLFT): a pass/fail fit test to assess the adequacy of respirator fit that relies on the individual's response to the test agent.
- L. QUANTITATIVE FIT TEST (QNFT): an assessment of the adequacy of respirator fit by numerically measuring the amount of leakage into the respirator.
- M. SELF-CONTAINED BREATHING APPARATUS (SCBA): an atmosphere-supplying respirator for which the breathing air source is designed to be carried by the user.
- N. SUPPLIED-AIR RESPIRATOR (SAR): (or airline respirator) an atmosphere-supplying respirator for which the source of breathing air is not designed to be carried by the user.
- O. TIGHT-FITTING FACEPIECE: a respiratory inlet covering that forms a complete seal with the face.
- P. USER SEAL CHECK: an action conducted by the respirator user to determine if the respirator is properly seated to the face.

RESPONSIBILITY

A. PROGRAM ADMINISTRATOR

The Calimesa Fire Department shall have *one* suitably trained and qualified Program Administrator Fire Captain, and at least one trained program "Fit – Test Operator" per shift.

The Program Administrator shall be responsible for the overall management of the Respiratory Protection Program (hereafter referred to as the "Program"). The Program Administrator shall ensure that the integrity of the Program is maintained through the continuous oversight of *one* responsible individual. Duties of the Program Administrator are:

1. Act as liaison between the Fire Department and the City Safety Officer.

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2. Ensure appropriate respirators are provided based on the respiratory hazards to which the worker is exposed and workplace and user factors that affect respirator performance and reliability.
3. Ensure selection of NIOSH-certified respirators and ensure that respirators are used in compliance with the conditions of its certification.
4. Ensure that employees have medical clearance from the City Department Physician prior to quantitative fit test.
5. Ensure completion of quantitative fit test prior to respirator use by employee.
6. Ensure appropriate training for employees is provided.
7. Provide, evaluate, and “update the Program as necessary to reflect those changes in workplace conditions that affect respirator use”.

B. SUPERVISOR

The Supervisor shall know the Program and ensure that each employee understands The Program prior to being placed into “IDLH” situations and/or performing “high risk” procedures. The Supervisor shall ensure that the Program is adhered to on a day to day and/or call by call basis. Duties of the Supervisor are:

1. Enforce the proper use of respiratory protection/respirators.
2. Ensure that each employee has received appropriate training and fit testing.
3. Ensure that respirators are properly cleaned, maintained, and stored according to the Program.
4. Monitor daily operations and work areas and identify potential respiratory hazards.
5. Address potential respiratory hazards and/or concerns regarding the Program with the Respiratory Protection Coordinator and/or the Program Administrator.
6. Ensure all routine maintenance and filter changes are completed by trained personnel in accordance with manufacturer’s instructions.

C. EMPLOYEE

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Each and every employee is obligated to wear his/her respirator when and where it is required in the manner in which he/she was trained according to the Program. Each and every employee shall know the Program and receive Fire Department training prior to being placed into a potential “IDLH” situation and/or perform any “high risk procedure”. Employees shall also:

1. Maintain appropriate personal hygiene so as not to interfere with the seal of his/her respirator.
2. Care for and maintain his/her respirator as trained.
3. Inform Supervisor if his/her respirator does not fit properly.
4. Advise Supervisor and/or Respiratory Protection Coordinator of any potential respiratory hazards and/or any other concerns he/she have regarding the Program.

AUTHORITY

- A. Federal Respiratory Protection Standard 29 CFR 1910.134
- B. Federal Respiratory Protection for M. tuberculosis Standard 29 CFR 1910.139
- C. California Code of Regulations Title 8 Subsection 5144
- D. California Code of Regulations Title 8 Subsection 5197

RESPIRATORY PROTECTION PROGRAM

A. SELECTION OF RESPIRATORS

1. The Calimesa Fire Department has selected and provided an appropriate respirator based on the hazards to which the employee is exposed.
2. The Calimesa Fire Department has selected NIOSH-certified positive pressure respirators. The respirator(s) shall be used in compliance with the conditions of its certification.
3. The Calimesa Fire Department has identified and evaluated respiratory hazards in the workplace. This evaluation has included a reasonable estimate of employee exposures to respiratory hazard(s) and identification of the contaminants’ chemical state and physical form. Where the Calimesa Fire Department cannot identify or reasonably estimate the employee exposure, the Calimesa Fire Department considers the atmosphere to be IDLH.

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4. The Calimesa Fire Department has selected respirators from a number of respirator models and sizes so that the respirator will be acceptable to, and will correctly fit the user.
5. Respirators for IDLH atmospheres:
 - a. All employees shall wear a properly fitted (fit tested) SCBA or SAR upon entering and/or working in any IDLH atmosphere.
 - (1) All oxygen deficient atmospheres shall be considered IDLH.
 - (2) The Calimesa Fire Department has provided full facepiece pressure demand SCBA's certified by NIOSH for a minimum service life of thirty minutes.
 - (3) The Calimesa Fire Department currently possesses combination full facepiece pressure demand supplied-air respirators (SAR) with auxiliary self-contained air supplies.
6. For protection against gases and vapors, the Calimesa Fire Department requires that the employee use an atmosphere-supplying respirator (SCBA or SAR).
7. For protection against particulates, Calimesa Fire Department provides the N95 respirator specifically for protection against Tuberculosis (*Mycobacterium tuberculosis*). The N95 is an air-purifying respirator approved by NIOSH. All employees must be fit tested with N95 prior to use.

B. MEDICAL EVALUATION

1. The Calimesa Fire Department requires that all employees undergo a medical evaluation to determine his/her ability to use a respirator before the employee is fit tested or required to use the respirator in the workplace.
2. Medical Evaluation Procedures:
 - a. The Calimesa Fire Department has identified Exam Professionals, Inc. as the licensed health care professional to perform medical evaluations using a medical questionnaire.

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- b. The medical evaluation obtains the information requested by Sections 1 and 2 of Appendix C of Federal Respiratory Protection Standard 29 CFR 1910.134.
- c. Exam Professionals, Inc. shall administer the questionnaire to the employees as part of the pre-employment medical evaluation process. The location is:

Exam Professionals, Inc.
1894 Commercenter West #106
San Bernardino, CA 92408

- 3. Follow-up Medical Evaluation:
 - a. The Program Administrator shall ensure that a follow-up medical examination is provided for an employee who gives a positive response to any question among questions 1 through 8 in Section 2, Part A of Appendix C of Federal Respiratory Protection Standard 29 CFR 1910.134.
 - b. The follow-up medical examination shall include any medical tests, consultations, or diagnostic procedures that the Department Physician deems necessary to make a final determination.
- 4. Administration of the Medical Questionnaire and Examinations:
 - a. The medical questionnaire and examinations shall be administered confidentially during the employee's normal working hours or at a time and place convenient to the employee. The medical questionnaire shall be administered in a manner that ensures that the employee understands its content.
 - b. The Calimesa Fire Department shall provide the employee with an opportunity to discuss the questionnaire and/or examination results with the Department Physician.
- 5. Supplemental Information for the Department Physician:
 - a. The Program Administrator shall provide to the Department Physician the following information before the Department Physician makes a recommendation concerning an employee's ability to use a respirator:

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- (1) The type and weight of the respirator to be used by the employee.
 - (2) The duration and frequency of respirator use;
 - (3) The expected physical work effort.
 - (4) Additional protective clothing and equipment to be worn; and
 - (5) Temperature and humidity extremes that may be encountered.
 - b. The Calimesa Fire Department shall provide the Department Physician with a copy of the written respiratory protection program and a copy of this section.
6. The Program Administrator shall obtain a written recommendation regarding the employee's ability to use the respirator from the Department Physician. The recommendation shall provide only the following information:
 - a. Any limitations on respirator use related to the medical condition of the employee, or relating to the workplace conditions in which the respirator will be used, including whether or not the employee is medically able to use the respirator;
 - b. The need, if any, for follow-up medical evaluations; and
 - c. A statement that the Department Physician has provided the employee with a copy of the Department Physician's written recommendation.
7. The Calimesa Fire Department shall provide additional medical evaluations that comply with the requirements of this section if:
 - a. An employee reports medical signs or symptoms that are related to ability to use a respirator;
 - b. The Department Physician, Supervisor, or Program Administrator informs the Department (Battalion) that an employee needs to be reevaluated;
 - c. Information from the respiratory protection program, including observations made during fit testing and program evaluation, indicates a need for employee reevaluation; or

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- d. A change occurs in workplace conditions (e.g., physical work effort, protective clothing, and temperature) that may result in a substantial increase in the physiological burden placed on an employee.

C. FIT TESTING

1. The Calimesa Fire Department requires that, before an employee uses any respirator with a negative or positive pressure tight-fitting facepiece (SCBA, SAR, or N95), the employee must be fit tested with the same make, model, style, and size of respirator that will be used.
2. The Calimesa Fire Department requires that employees, using a tight-fitting facepiece respirator (SCBA, SAR, or N95), pass the Quantitative Fit Test adopted by the Calimesa Fire Department.
3. The Calimesa Fire Department requires that employees, using tight-fitting facepiece respirators, are fit tested prior to initial use of the respirator, whenever a different facepiece (size, style, model or make) respirator used, and at least annually thereafter.
4. The Calimesa Fire Department shall conduct an additional fit test whenever the employee reports, or the Calimesa Fire Department is advised of or takes notice of changes in the employee's physical condition that could affect respirator fit. Such conditions include, but are not limited to, facial scarring, dental changes, cosmetic surgery, or an obvious change in bodyweight.
5. If after passing the Department approved Quantitative Fit Test, the employee subsequently notifies his/her supervisor, that the fit of the N95 respirator is unacceptable, the employee shall be given a reasonable opportunity to select a different respirator to be retested.
6. The fit test shall be administered using the Calimesa Fire Department OSHA-accepted QNFT protocol.
7. The fit test for SCBA's shall be accomplished in the negative pressure mode.
 - a. Fit testing of the SCBA's shall be accomplished by temporarily converting the employee's actual facepiece into a negative pressure respirator with appropriate filters.

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- b. Any modifications to the respirator facepiece for fit testing shall be completely removed, and the facepiece restored to NIOSH-approved configuration, before that facepiece can be used in the workplace.

D. USE OF RESPIRATORS

1. Facepiece Seal Protection:

- a. The Calimesa Fire Department does not permit respirators with a tight-fitting facepiece (SCBA and N95) to be worn by employees who have:
 - (1) Facial hair that comes between the sealing surface of the facepiece and the face or that interferes with valve function; or
 - (2) Any condition that interferes with the face-to-facepiece seal or valve function.
- b. If an employee wears corrective glasses or goggles or other personal protective equipment, the Calimesa Fire Department requires that such equipment is worn in a manner that does not interfere with the seal of the facepiece to the face of the user.
- c. For the SCBA and N95, the Calimesa Fire Department requires that employees perform a user seal check each time they put on the respirator using proper seal check procedures.(see Appendix A)

2. Continuing Respirator Effectiveness:

- a. The Calimesa Fire Department shall evaluate workplace conditions routinely so that additional respiratory protection or different respiratory protection can be provided, when necessary.
- b. The Calimesa Fire Department requires that employees leave the respirator use area if they detect vapor or gas breakthrough, changes in breathing resistance, or leakage of the facepiece. The Department will then replace or repair the respirator before allowing the employee to return to the work area. The respirator will be tagged and marked OOS pending repair.

E. MAINTENANCE AND CARE OF RESPIRATORS

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1. Cleaning and Disinfecting:
 - a. SCBA's and/or SAR's shall be cleaned and disinfected after each use and more often if necessary.
2. Storage:
 - a. All respirators shall be stored to protect them from damage, contamination, dust, sunlight, extreme temperatures, excessive moisture, and damaging chemicals, and they shall be stored to prevent deformation of the face piece and exhalation valve.
 - b. Respirators shall be kept accessible to the work area.
 - c. Respirators shall be stored in compartments (N95) or in covers (SCBA's and SAR's).
3. Inspection:
 - a. The Calimesa Fire Department requires that all respirators be inspected at least weekly and in accordance with the manufacturer's recommendations and shall be checked for proper function before and after each use. Weekly checks shall be logged on the SCBA weekly record form in the appropriate vehicle logbook. This form shall stay with the vehicle log and be routed to District files at year-end.
 - b. Respirator checks shall include inspection of the regulator, low air warning system, and personal alarm device to determine that they are functioning properly.
 - c. Air cylinders shall be maintained in a fully charged state and shall be recharged when the pressure falls to 90% of the manufacturer's recommended pressure level.
4. Repairs: The Calimesa Fire Department requires that respirators that fail an inspection or are otherwise found to be defective are removed from service, and are discarded, repaired or adjusted in accordance with the following procedures:
 - a. Complete Apparatus-Equipment Repair Form and attach 402.11 to the respirator.

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- b. All repairs are to be performed by a certified repair technician or an authorized service center. Repair technicians are fire department employees that are trained and certified by the manufacturer.
 - c. Fire department certified repair technicians shall perform repairs when appropriate. When repair exceeds department repair technician scope of training, the repair shall be performed by an authorized service center.
 - d. The respirator shall be returned to service after repair has been completed. Note repair on S-1 and SCBA Record Form. (See Appendix G)
- 5. Flow Testing:
 - a. All SCBA's shall be flow tested by a certified repair technician after repairs are performed or as recommended by the manufacturer.
 - b. The completed Flow Test Record shall be forwarded to the Respiratory Protection Coordinator to be filed.
- 6. SCBA Tracking:
 - a. The serial number, county identification number, or other assigned identification number, will be used to track each SCBA for maintenance and inventory purposes.
 - b. Each SCBA will be assigned to a specific piece of apparatus or location for tracking purposes.
 - c. Logs shall list each SCBA by serial number, county identification number, or other assigned identification number.
 - d. When an SCBA is removed from service, or reassigned, the Log shall reflect the change.
 - e. The Respiratory Protection Coordinator shall update the tracking form as changes are made. (i.e. repairs, flow testing, and/or respirators are reassigned)
- 7. SCBA Air Cylinder Tracking:
 - a. All SCBA air cylinders shall be tracked for hydrostatic testing and/or repair purposes.

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- b. The Respiratory Protection Coordinator shall update the tracking form as changes are made. (i.e. repairs, hydrostatic testing, and/or cylinders are reassigned)
- 8. Hydrostatic Testing:
 - a. Steel air cylinders shall be tested every 5 years.
 - b. Aluminum air cylinders shall be tested every 5 years.
 - c. Composite “wrapped” air cylinders shall be tested every three years and shall not be kept in service longer than 15 years.

F. BREATHING AIR QUALITY AND USE

- 1. The Calimesa Fire Department requires that compressed oxygen meets the United States Pharmacopoeia for medical or breathing oxygen and that compressed breathing air meets, at least, the requirements for Grade D breathing air described in ANSI/Compressed Gas Association Commodity Specification for Air, G-7.1-1989, to include:
 - a. Oxygen content of 19.5-23.5%;
 - b. Hydrocarbon (condensed) content of 5 milligrams per cubic meter of air or less;
 - c. Carbon monoxide (CO) content of 10 ppm or less;
 - d. Carbon dioxide (CO₂) content of 1,000 ppm or less; and
 - e. Lack of noticeable odor.
- 2. The Calimesa Fire Department requires that oxygen concentrations greater than 23.5% are used only in equipment designed for oxygen service or distribution.
- 3. The Calimesa Fire Department requires that cylinders used to supply breathing air to respirators meet the following requirements:
 - a. Cylinders are tested and maintained as prescribed in the Shipping Container Specification Regulations of the Department of Transportation (49 CFR part 173 and part 178)

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- b. Cylinders of purchased breathing air have a certificate of analysis from the supplier that the breathing air meets the requirements for Grade D breathing air; and
 - c. The moisture content in the cylinder does not exceed a dew point of -50°F (-45.6°C) at 1 atmosphere pressure.
- 4. The Calimesa Fire Department requires that compressors used to supply breathing air to respirators are constructed and situated so as to:
 - a. Prevent entry of contaminated air into the supply system;
 - b. Minimize moisture content so that the dew point at 1 atmosphere pressure is 10°F (-5.56°C) below the ambient temperature;
 - c. Have suitable in-line air-purifying sorbent beds and filters to further ensure breathing air quality. Sorbent beds and filters shall be maintained and replaced or refurbished periodically following the manufacturer's instructions.
 - d. Have a tag containing the most recent change date and the signature of the person authorized by the Department to perform the change. The tag shall be maintained at the compressor.
 - e. Compressors shall be inspected yearly.
- 5. For compressors that are not oil-lubricated, the Department requires that carbon monoxide (CO) levels in the breathing air do not exceed 10ppm.
- 6. For oil-lubricated compressors, the Department requires a high-temperature or carbon monoxide alarm, or both, to monitor carbon monoxide levels. If only high temperature alarms are used, the air supply shall be monitored at intervals sufficient to prevent carbon monoxide in the breathing air from exceeding 10 p.m.
- 7. The Calimesa Fire Department requires that breathing gas containers are marked in accordance with the NIOSH respiratory certification standard, 42 CFR part 84.

G. IDENTIFICATION OF FILTERS, CARTRIDGES, AND CANISTERS

The Calimesa Fire Department requires that all filters, cartridges, and canisters used in the workplace are labeled and color coded with the NIOSH approval label and that the label is not removed and remains legible.

H. TRAINING AND INFORMATION

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The Calimesa Fire Department will provide effective training to employees required to use respirators. The training will be comprehensive, understandable, recur annually, and more often if necessary.

1. The Calimesa Fire Department will ensure that each employee can demonstrate knowledge of at least the following:
 - a. Why the respirator is necessary and how improper fit, usage, or maintenance can compromise the protective effect of the respirator;
 - b. What the limitations and capabilities of the respirator are;
 - c. How to use the respirator effectively in emergency situations, including situations in which the respirator malfunctions;
 - d. How to inspect, put on and remove, use, and check the seals of the respirator;
 - e. What the procedures are for maintenance and storage of the respirator;
 - f. How to recognize medical signs and symptoms that may limit or prevent the effective use of respirators.
2. The Calimesa Fire Department shall provide the training before requiring the employee to use a respirator in the workplace.
3. The training shall be conducted in a manner that is understandable to the employee.
4. Retraining shall be administered annually, and when the following situations occur:
 - a. Changes in the workplace or the type of respirator render previous training obsolete;
 - b. Inadequacies in the employee's knowledge or use of the respirator indicate that the employee has not retained the requisite understanding or skill; or
 - c. Any other situation arises in which retraining appears necessary to ensure safe respirator use.

I. PROGRAM EVALUATION

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1. The Calimesa Fire Department Program Administrator shall conduct evaluations of the workplace as necessary to ensure that the provisions of the current written program are being effectively implemented and it continues to be effective.
2. The Calimesa Fire Department Program Administrator shall regularly consult employees required to use respirators to assess employees' views on program effectiveness and to identify any problems. Any problems that are identified during this assessment shall be corrected. Factors to be assessed include, but are not limited to :
 - a. Respirator fit (including the ability to use the respirator without interfering with effective workplace performance);
 - b. Appropriate respirator selection for the hazards to which the employee is exposed;
 - c. Proper respirator use under the workplace conditions the employee encounters; and
 - d. Proper respirator maintenance.

J. RECORDKEEPING

1. Medical Evaluation. Records of medical evaluations will be retained and made available by Calimesa Fire Department in accordance with California Code of Regulations Title 8, Section 3204.
2. Fit Testing. The Calimesa Fire Department shall establish a record(See Appendix) of the quantitative fit tests administered to an employee including:
 - a. The name or the identification of the employee tested;
 - b. Type of fit test performed;
 - c. Specific make, model, style, and size of respirator tested;
 - d. Date of test; and
 - e. The pass/fail results for the quantitative fit test.

(Fit test records shall be retained for respirator users until the next fit test is administered).

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3. The Calimesa Fire Department shall retain a written a written copy of the current respiratory program.
4. Written materials required to be retained under this subsection shall be made available upon request to affected employees and to the Fire Chief or designee for examination and copying.

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Appendix A

How user seal checks are conducted

To conduct a user seal check, the worker performs a negative or positive pressure fit check.

- For the negative pressure check, the worker:
 - covers the respirator inlets (cartridges, canister, or seals)
 - gently inhales, and
 - holds breath for 10 seconds

The facepiece should collapse on the worker's face and remain collapsed.

- For the positive pressure check, the worker:
 - covers the respirator exhalation valve(s); and
 - exhales

The facepiece should hold the positive pressure for a few seconds. During this time, the worker should not hear or feel the air leaking out of the face-to-facepiece seal.

The Respiratory Protection Standard provides detailed instructions on how to conduct the user seal check.

The manufacturer's recommended procedures for checking the facepiece seal may be used if the employer demonstrates that the manufacturer's procedures are as effective as those described in Appendix B-1 of the Respiratory Protection standard, e.g., these procedures are effective in identifying respirators that fit poorly when put on or adjusted.

Can a user seal check be used as a substitute for a qualitative fit test?

A user seal check is *not* a substitute for a qualitative fit test. Fit testing is a more rigorous procedure that is used to determine whether the respirator fits the face of the worker. Section(f) of this Compliance Guide contains a complete discussion on respirator fit testing.

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1910.134: OSHA Respirator Medical Evaluation Questionnaire (Mandatory)

To the employer:

Answers to questions in Section 1, and to question 9 in Section 2 Part A, do not require a medical examination.

To the employee:

Can you read (circle one): Yes No

Your employer must allow you to answer this questionnaire during normal working hours, or at a time and place that is convenient to you. To maintain your confidentiality, your employer or supervisor must not look at or review your answers, and your employer must tell you how to deliver or send this questionnaire to the health care professional who will review it.

Part A. Section 1: (Mandatory) The following information must be provided by every employee who has been selected to use any type of respirator (please print).

1. Today's date: _____
2. Your name: _____
3. Your age (to nearest year): _____
4. Sex (circle one): Male Female
5. Your height: _____ ft. _____ in.
6. Your weight: _____ lbs.
7. Your job title: _____
8. A phone number where you can be reached by the health care professional who reviews this questionnaire (include the area code): _____
9. The best time to phone you at this number: _____
10. Has your employer told you how to contact the health care professional who will review this questionnaire (circle one): Yes No
11. Check the type of respirator you will use (you can check more than one category):
 - a. _____ N, R, or P disposable respirator (filter-mask, non-cartridge type only).
 - b. _____ Other type (for example, half or full-facepiece type, powered -air purifying supplied air, self-contained breathing apparatus)

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12. Have you worn a respirator (circle one): Yes No
If "yes", what type(s): _____

Part A. Section 2 (Mandatory): Questions 1 through 9 below must be answered by every employee who has been selected to use any type of respirator (Please circle "yes" or "no").

1. Do you currently smoke tobacco, or have you smoked tobacco in the last month: Yes No
2. Have you ever had any of the following conditions?
- | | | |
|---|-----|----|
| a. Seizures (fits) | Yes | No |
| b. Diabetes (sugar disease): | Yes | No |
| c. Allergic reactions that interfere with your breathing: | Yes | No |
| d. Claustrophobia (fear of closed-in places): | Yes | No |
| e. Trouble smelling odors (except when you had a cold): | Yes | No |
3. Have you ever had any of the following pulmonary or lung problems?
- | | | |
|--|-----|----|
| a. Asbestosis: | Yes | No |
| b. Asthma: | Yes | No |
| c. Chronic bronchitis: | Yes | No |
| d. Emphysema: | Yes | No |
| e. Pneumonia: | Yes | No |
| f. Tuberculosis: | Yes | No |
| g. Silicosis: | Yes | No |
| h. Pneumothorax (collapsed lung): | Yes | No |
| i. Lung cancer: | Yes | No |
| j. Broken ribs: | Yes | No |
| k. Any chest injuries or surgeries: | Yes | No |
| l. Any other lung problem that you have been told about: | Yes | No |
4. Do you currently have any of the following symptoms of pulmonary or lung illness?
- | | | |
|--|-----|----|
| a. Shortness of breath: | Yes | No |
| b. Shortness of breath when walking fast on level ground or walking up a slight hill or incline: | Yes | No |
| c. Shortness of breath when walking with other people at an ordinary pace on level ground: | Yes | No |
| d. Have to stop for breath when walking at your own pace on level ground: | Yes | No |
| e. Shortness of breath when washing or dressing yourself: | Yes | No |
| f. Shortness of breath that interferes with your job: | Yes | No |
| g. Coughing that produces phlegm (thick sputum): | Yes | No |
| h. Coughing that wakes you early in the morning: | Yes | No |
| i. Coughing that occurs mostly when you are lying down: | Yes | No |
| j. Coughing up blood in the last month: | Yes | No |
| k. Wheezing: | Yes | No |
| l. Wheezing that interferes with your job: | Yes | No |

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- | | | | |
|----|--|-----|----|
| m. | Chest pain when you breathe deeply: | Yes | No |
| n. | Any other symptoms that you think may be related to lung problems: | Yes | No |
5. Have you ever had any of the following cardiovascular or heart problems?
- | | | | |
|----|--|-----|----|
| a. | Heart attack: | Yes | No |
| b. | Stroke: | Yes | No |
| c. | Angina: | Yes | No |
| d. | Heart failure: | Yes | No |
| e. | Swelling in your leg or feet (not caused by walking): | Yes | No |
| f. | Heart arrhythmia (heart beating irregularly): | Yes | No |
| g. | High blood pressure: | Yes | No |
| h. | Any other heart problem that you have been told about: | Yes | No |
6. Have you ever had any of the following cardiovascular or heart symptoms?
- | | | | |
|----|--|-----|----|
| a. | Frequent pain or tightness in your chest: | Yes | No |
| b. | Pain or tightness in your chest during physical activity: | Yes | No |
| c. | Pain or tightness in your chest that interferes with your job: | Yes | No |
| d. | In the past two years, have you noticed your heart skipping or missing a beat: | Yes | No |
| e. | Heartburn or indigestion that is not related to eating: | Yes | No |
| f. | Any other symptoms that you think may be related to heart or circulation problems: | Yes | No |
7. Do you currently take medication for any of the following problems?
- | | | | |
|----|-----------------------------|-----|----|
| a. | Breathing or lung problems: | Yes | No |
| b. | Heart trouble: | Yes | No |
| c. | Blood pressure: | Yes | No |
| d. | Seizures (fits): | Yes | No |
8. If you have ever used a respirator, have you ever had any of the following problems?
(If you've never used a respirator, check the following space and go to question 9:)
- | | | | |
|----|--|-----|----|
| a. | Eye irritation: | Yes | No |
| b. | Skin allergies or rashes: | Yes | No |
| c. | Anxiety: | Yes | No |
| d. | General weakness or fatigue: | Yes | No |
| e. | Any other problem that interferes with your use of a respirator: | Yes | No |
9. Would you like to talk to the health care professional who will review this questionnaire about your answers to this questionnaire:
- | | | |
|--|-----|----|
| | Yes | No |
|--|-----|----|

Questions 10 to 15 below must be answered by every employee who has been selected to use either a full-facepiece respirator or a self-contained breathing apparatus (SCBA). For employees who have been selected to use other types of respirators, answering these questions is voluntary.

- | | | | |
|-----|---|-----|----|
| 10. | Have you ever lost vision in either eye (temporarily or permanently): | Yes | No |
| 11. | Do you currently have any of the following vision problems? | | |
| a. | Wear contact lenses: | Yes | No |

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- | | | | |
|-----|---|-----|----|
| b. | Wear glasses: | Yes | No |
| c. | Color blind: | Yes | No |
| d. | Any other eye or vision problem: | Yes | No |
| 12. | Have you ever had an injury to your ears, including a broken ear drum? | Yes | No |
| 13. | Do you currently have any of the following hearing problems? | | |
| a. | Difficulty hearing: | Yes | No |
| b. | Wear a hearing aid: | Yes | No |
| c. | Any other hearing or ear problem: | Yes | No |
| 14. | Have you ever had a back injury? | Yes | No |
| 15. | Do you currently have any of the following musculoskeletal problems? | | |
| a. | Weakness in any of your arms, hands, legs, or feet: | Yes | No |
| b. | Back pain: | Yes | No |
| c. | Difficulty fully moving your arms and legs: | Yes | No |
| d. | Pain and stiffness when you lean forward or backward at the waist: | Yes | No |
| e. | Difficulty fully moving your head up or down: | Yes | No |
| f. | Difficulty fully moving your head side to side: | Yes | No |
| g. | Difficulty bending at your knees: | Yes | No |
| h. | Difficulty squatting to the ground: | Yes | No |
| i. | Climbing a flight of stairs or a ladder carrying more than 25 lbs.: | Yes | No |
| j. | Any other muscle or skeletal problem that interferes with using a respirator: | Yes | No |

Part B Any of the following questions, and other questions not listed, may be added to the questionnaire at the discretion of the health care profession who will review the questionnaire.

- | | | | |
|----|---|-----|----|
| 1. | In your present job, are you working at high altitudes (over 5,000 feet) or in a place that has lower than normal amounts of oxygen? | Yes | No |
| | If "yes", do you have feelings of dizziness, shortness of breath, pounding in your chest, or other symptoms when you're working under these conditions: | Yes | No |
| 2. | At work or at home, have you ever been exposed to hazardous solvents, hazardous airborne chemicals (e.g., gasses, fumes, or dust), or have you come into skin contact with hazardous chemicals: | Yes | No |
| | If "yes", name the chemical if you know them: _____ | | |
| 3. | Have you ever worked with any of the materials, or under any of the conditions, listed below: | | |
| a. | Asbestos: | Yes | No |
| b. | Silica (e.g., in sandblasting): | Yes | No |
| c. | Tungsten/cobalt (e.g., grinding or welding this material): | Yes | No |
| d. | Beryllium: | Yes | No |
| e. | Aluminum: | Yes | No |
| f. | Coal (for example, mining): | Yes | No |
| g. | Iron: | Yes | No |

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h.	Tin:	Yes	No
i.	Dusty environments:	Yes	No
j.	Any other hazardous exposures:	Yes	No

If "yes," describe these exposures:

4. List any second jobs or side businesses you have:

5. List your previous occupations:

6. List your current and previous hobbies:

7.	Have you been in the military services?	Yes	No
	If "yes," were you exposed to biological or chemical agents (either in training or combat):	Yes	No

8. Have you ever worked on a HAZ-MAT team? Yes No

9. Other than medications for breathing and lung problems, heart trouble, blood pressure, and seizures mentioned earlier in this questionnaire, are you taking any other medications for any reason (including over the counter): Yes No

10. Describe any special or hazardous conditions you might encounter when you're using your respirator(s) (for example, confined spaces)

11. Provide the following information, if you know it, for each toxic substance that you will be exposed to when you're using your respirator(s):

Name of the first toxic substance: _____

Estimated maximum exposure level per shift: _____

Duration of exposure per shift: _____

Name of second toxic substance: _____

Estimated maximum exposure level per shift: _____

Duration of exposure per shift: _____

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The name of any other toxic substances that you will be exposed to while using your respirator:

12. Describe any special responsibilities you'll have while using your respirator(s) that may affect the safety and well-being of others (for example, rescue, security):

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This Heat Illness Prevention Program Policy is to minimize heat illness to all employees in the City of Calimesa Fire Department

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1. Background:

The Calimesa Fire Department is located in an area of the State of California where outdoor heat can generate heat illness in an unsuspecting employee. This Heat Illness Prevention Program:

- a. Establishes what the Organization has in place to control the risk of heat illness.
- b. Applies to all outdoor places of employment at those times when the environmental risk factors for heat illness are present.
- c. Complies with Section 3395 of the California Code of Regulations, Title 8.

2. Provision of Water:

Employees have access to cool potable drinking water. Such water is provided in sufficient quantities throughout any given shift to provide at least one quart per employee per hour for drinking for the entire shift when the work environment is hot, and employees are likely to be sweating more than usual in the performance of their duties.

- a. Such water is provided at the beginning of the work shift so employees can take it with them when they travel away from organization offices and shops, and they are exposed to working outside in extreme heat. When needed, additional water can be retrieved during any given shift to replenish water resources.
- b. Otherwise, if work is being conducted around organization facilities, drinking water is available in these facilities.
- c. Managers and supervisors encourage the frequent drinking of water.

3. Access to Shade:

- a. When the Temperature Exceeds 85 Degrees Fahrenheit:

Shade is required to be present when the temperature exceeds 85 degrees Fahrenheit. When the outdoor temperature in the work area exceeds 85 degrees Fahrenheit, employees who are present are provided at all times with one or more areas with shade that are either open to the air or provided with ventilation or cooling. The amount of shade present is at least enough to accommodate 25% of the employees on the shift at any time, so they can sit in a normal posture fully in the shade without having to be in physical contact with each other. The shaded area is located as close as practicable to the areas where employees are working.

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b. When the Temperature Does not Exceed 85 Degrees Fahrenheit:

Shade is also required to be available when the temperature does not exceed 85 degrees Fahrenheit. When the outdoor temperature in the work area does not exceed 85 degrees Fahrenheit, shade is provided either:

1. In accordance with paragraph 3.a. or
2. Upon an employee's request. If an employee requests shade, it is provided in a timely manner.

c. Cool Down Rest in the Shade:

Employees are permitted and encouraged to take a cool-down rest in the shade for a period of not less than five minutes at a time when they feel the need to do so to protect themselves from overheating. Such access to shade is permitted at all times.

d. Exceptions to paragraph 3(a)(b)(c):

1. Where management can demonstrate it is infeasible or unsafe to have a shade structure, or otherwise to have shade present on a continuous basis, management may utilize alternative procedures for providing access to shade if the alternative procedures provide equivalent protection.
2. Cooling measures other than shade (for example, use of misting machines) may be provided in lieu of shade if management can demonstrate these measures are at least as effective as shade in allowing employees to cool down.

4. **High-heat Procedures:**

Management implements high-heat procedures when the temperature equals or exceeds 95 degrees Fahrenheit. These procedures include the following actions to the extent practicable:

- a. Ensuring effective communication by voice, observation, or electronic means is maintained so employees at the work site can contact a supervisor when necessary. An electronic device, such as a cell phone or text-messaging device may be used for this purpose only if reception in the area is reliable.
- b. Observing employees for alertness and signs or symptoms of heat illness.

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- c. Reminding employees throughout the work shift to drink plenty of water.
- d. Close supervision of a new employee by a supervisor or designee for the first 14 days of the employee's employment, unless the employee indicates at the time of hire he or she has been doing similar outdoor work for at least 10 of the past 30 days for four or more hours per day.
- e. When the temperature reaches 90 degrees the Class B uniform shirt may be removed and staff may operate in the issued department t-shirt. However, the Class B uniform shirt must be worn when meeting with the public.

5. Medical Attention:

In the event an employee starts to show symptoms of heat exhaustion or heat stroke, medical attention is immediately obtained. See the Table under *Types of Heat Illness* for typical actions to be taken.

6. Training:

a. Employee Training

Effective training in the following topics is provided to each supervisory and non-supervisory employee before the employee begins work that should reasonably be anticipated to result in exposure to the risk of heat illness while working outdoors:

- 1. The environmental and personal risk factors for heat illness as well as the added burden of heat load on the body caused by exertion, clothing, and personal protective equipment.
- 2. The organization's procedures for complying with the requirements of this Program to include, but not be limited to identifying, evaluating, and controlling exposures to the environmental and personal risk factors for heat illness.
- 3. The importance of frequent consumption of small quantities of water, up to four cups per hour when the work environment is hot and employees are likely to be sweating more than usual in the performance of their duties.
- 4. The importance of acclimatization.

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5. The different types of heat illness and the common signs and symptoms of heat illness.
6. The importance to employees of immediately reporting to their supervisor any symptoms or signs of heat illness in themselves or co-workers.
7. The procedures for responding to symptoms of possible heat illness, including how emergency medical services are provided should they become necessary, and what kind of first-aid treatment should be provided for kind of heat illness.
8. Procedures for contacting emergency medical services, and if necessary, for transporting employees to a point where they can be reached by an emergency medical service provider.
9. How to provide clear and concise directions to the work site. Designating person to be available to ensure established emergency procedures are initiated when appropriate.

b. Supervisor Training

Prior to supervising employees performing work that should reasonably be anticipated to result in exposure to the risk of heat illness, effective training on the following topics is provided to the supervisor:

1. The information required to be provided by paragraph 6.a. above.
2. The procedures the supervisor is to follow to implement the applicable provisions of this Program.
3. The procedures the supervisor is to follow when an employee exhibits symptoms consistent with possible heat illness, including emergency response procedures.
4. How to monitor weather reports and how to respond to hot weather advisories.

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Important Information about Heat Illness

Information taken from the following web sites:

- ▶ Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC) - Updated August 19, 2010
- ▶ National Weather Service Forecast Office

People suffer heat-related illness when their bodies are unable to compensate and properly cool themselves. The body normally cools itself by sweating. But under some conditions, sweating just isn't enough. In some cases, a person's body temperature rises rapidly. Very high body temperatures may damage the brain and other vital organs.

Several factors affect the body's ability to cool itself during extremely hot weather. When the humidity is high, sweat will not evaporate as quickly, preventing the body from releasing heat quickly. Other conditions related to risk include age (65 or older), obesity, fever, dehydration, heart disease, mental illness, poor circulation, sunburn and prescription drug and alcohol use.

Air conditioning is the number one protective factor against heat-related illness and death.

Work activity under hot conditions must be balanced with measures that aid the body's cooling mechanisms and prevent heat-related illness.

Remember, thirst is a late response to fluid depletion.

Prevention and early detection are the keys.

Even short periods of high temperatures can cause serious health problems.

1. Extreme Heat

Temperatures that hover 10 degrees or more above the average high temperature for the region and last for several weeks are defined as extreme heat. Humid or muggy conditions, which add to the discomfort of high temperatures, occur when a *dome* of high atmospheric pressure traps hazy, damp air near the ground. A heat wave combined with a drought is a very dangerous situation.

2. Types of Heat Illness

- a. **Sunburn** is caused by too much exposure to the sun on the skin. Although the discomfort is usually minor and healing often occurs in about a week, more severe sunburn may require medical attention.

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- b. **Beat Rash** is a skin irritation caused by excessive sweating during hot, humid weather.
- c. **Beat Syncope** occurs when a person faints suddenly and loses consciousness or gets dizzy. Heat causes the blood vessels to expand (dilate), so body fluid moves into the legs by gravity, which causes low blood pressure and may result in fainting. It is mainly caused by blood pooling in the legs due to standing still for a long time in a hot environment. It can also be caused by vigorous physical activity for two or more hours before the symptoms appear. The risk of developing heat syncope increases when the person has not adjusted (acclimated) to a hot environment. Being dehydrated may also increase the risk. Heat syncope can be a symptom of a nervous system, metabolic, or cardiovascular problem that needs further medical evaluation.
- d. **Beat Cramps** usually affect people who sweat a lot during strenuous activity. This sweating depletes the body's salt and moisture. The low salt level in the muscles causes painful cramps. Heat cramps may also be a symptom of **heat exhaustion**.
- e. **Beat Exhaustion** is a milder form of heat illness that can develop after several days of exposure to high temperatures and inadequate or unbalanced replacement of fluids. It is the body's response to an excessive loss of the water and salt contained in sweat. Those people most prone to heat exhaustion are older, people with high blood pressure, and people working or exercising in a hot environment.
- f. **Beat Stroke** is the most serious heat-related disorder. It occurs when the body becomes unable to control its temperature. The body's temperature rises rapidly, the sweating mechanism fails, and the body is unable to cool down. Body temperature may rise to 106° F. or higher within 10 to 15 minutes. Heat stroke can cause death or permanent disability if emergency treatment is not provided quickly.